JAMES EDWARD HARTLEY

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github.com/jhartley-eng

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Principal Engineer with 10 years of experience building scalable infrastructure and leading technical teams across financial services and cloud platforms. I've spent the last four years architecting distributed systems handling millions of transactions daily, mentoring a team of seven engineers, and establishing engineering practices that reduced deployment times by 60%. I'm particularly interested in solving complex systems problems and helping teams make better architectural decisions early on.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Go, Python, Java, TypeScript, SQL, Bash

Cloud Platforms: AWS, Google Cloud Platform, Azure

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Cassandra

Infrastructure: Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, CloudFormation

Tools and Frameworks: gRPC, REST APIs, Apache Kafka, ElasticSearch

DevOps: CI/CD pipelines, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, monitoring and observability

WORK EXPERIENCE

Principal Engineer

CloudScale Systems

cloudscale.io

London, United Kingdom

March 2022 - Present

Designed and implemented a multi-region Kubernetes infrastructure handling 500K requests per second across 12 data centres, reducing latency by 35% for customer applications

Led architectural review process for 8 platform teams, establishing standardised patterns for service communication and improving code consistency across 60+ microservices

Mentored four senior engineers on distributed systems design and cloud-native patterns, with two promoted to staff level roles within 18 months

Established SLO framework for 45 services, implemented comprehensive monitoring using Prometheus and Grafana, reducing mean time to resolution from 4 hours to 12 minutes

Senior Infrastructure Engineer

Vertex Financial Systems

vertexfs.co

Oxford, United Kingdom

July 2018 - February 2022

Built disaster recovery infrastructure for banking systems processing 2 billion GBP daily, achieving 99.99% uptime across three availability zones using PostgreSQL and automated failover mechanisms

Migrated monolithic Java application to event-driven microservices architecture using Kafka and gRPC, reducing deployment frequency from monthly to hourly releases

Developed internal platform tooling in Go and Python that reduced infrastructure provisioning time from three weeks to two hours, enabling 15% faster feature delivery

Managed team of five engineers responsible for production systems, implementing on-call rotations and runbooks that improved incident response and team satisfaction

Software Engineer

TechBridge Solutions

techbridge.net

Reading, United Kingdom

September 2014 - June 2018

Developed REST APIs in Java and Python serving 50 million requests monthly for media distribution platform, implementing caching strategies that reduced database load by 40%

Containerised legacy applications using Docker and orchestrated deployment pipelines with Jenkins and Kubernetes, enabling seamless releases across 30+ environments

Optimised database queries and indexing strategy for high-traffic e-commerce platform, improving query performance by 5x and supporting 10x traffic growth without infrastructure expansion

Contributed to infrastructure automation using Terraform and CloudFormation, reducing manual deployment tasks by 70% and improving consistency across AWS environments

EDUCATION

MEng Computer Science (First Class Honours)

University of Oxford

Oxford, United Kingdom

2010 - 2014

CERTIFICATIONS AND ACHIEVEMENTS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Professional

Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD)

Published article on distributed consensus algorithms in IEEE Software Engineering journal

Speaker at KubeCon Europe 2023 on multi-region Kubernetes architectures

GITHUB REPOSITORIES

github.com/jhartley-eng/kafka-bridge - Go library for streaming data pipelines with Kafka

github.com/jhartley-eng/terraform-aws-modules - Reusable Terraform modules for AWS infrastructure

github.com/jhartley-eng/golang-microservice-template - Starter template for building microservices in Go

github.com/jhartley-eng/distributed-tracing-guide - Educational examples of implementing distributed tracing with Jaeger and OpenTelemetry